TEAM 3 | RAG HACKATHON BRIEF

Legal Workspace

Persistent AI Matter Intelligence for Indian Commercial & Contract Litigation

Track: Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG)

1. Problem Statement

Legal matters evolve continuously. A matter may begin with a complaint, petition, agreement, notice or other filing, and then accumulate pleadings, evidence, correspondence, affidavits, applications, hearing notes, court orders and new legal arguments. New information can introduce facts, contradict earlier positions, supersede previous understanding or create new directions and deadlines.

Build a persistent Legal Workspace that maintains an evidence-grounded understanding of a case as new information arrives. The workspace should combine matter-specific documents with relevant public legal knowledge so that it can answer factual questions about the case, retrieve applicable law or precedent when needed, and always reflect the latest available information with traceable source references.

What It Solves

The goal is not a document chatbot. The goal is a persistent case memory that helps a lawyer quickly understand the current position of a matter, what changed, which facts are disputed, what evidence supports or contradicts each position, what the court has directed, which legal authorities are relevant, and what needs to be prepared next.

2. Legal Scope

The challenge is intentionally limited to Indian commercial and contract litigation. Teams may develop and test using any of these matter archetypes:

Matter archetype	Typical dispute
Breach / Non-Performance	Delay, failure to deliver, SLA breach, quality or scope disputes
Payment / Recovery	Unpaid invoices, disputed milestones, deductions, withheld payments, damages
Termination / Injunction	Wrongful termination, notice/cure disputes, continued performance, interim relief

Out of scope: criminal, family, land/revenue, tax and IP matters; legal outcome prediction; and building an all-India case-law search engine.

3. What the Team Must Build

- A matter workspace where a user can create/open a case and ingest its documents.
- A RAG/agent harness that retrieves the right information for different questions such as gist, chronology, evidence, what changed, hearing preparation and legal research.
- Incremental matter memory so new pleadings, evidence or orders can be added without retraining the model.
- Grounded answers with document/page or equivalent source references for important factual and legal statements.

4. Core Behaviour

- Explain the current matter and build a chronology from the available evidence.
- Separate claims, counterclaims, defences and relief sought by each party.
- Map important assertions to supporting or contradicting evidence.
- Understand court directions, deadlines, undertakings and pending actions.
- Detect what changed when new documents are added and avoid repeating facts that are contradicted or superseded.
- Prepare a concise hearing brief based on the latest state of the matter.
- Retrieve relevant statutes or judgments when a question requires legal context.

5. Development Matter Documents

Teams should create synthetic commercial/contract matter documents to build and test the ingestion, retrieval and agent/harness logic. Useful document types include:

- Main contract, SOW, purchase order, amendments and change requests
- Emails, correspondence and meeting minutes
- Invoices, payment records and other supporting evidence
- Legal notice and reply
- Plaint/petition and written statement/counter
- Affidavits, rejoinders and applications
- Court orders and hearing notes

The synthetic matter data is for building and validating the RAG/agent harness; it is not a model-training dataset.

6. Public Legal Knowledge - Part of the Dataset

The dataset should also include a small public legal-knowledge corpus because some questions cannot be answered from case documents alone. The workspace should be able to retrieve the applicable law or precedent when preparing an answer or hearing brief.

- Relevant provisions from the Indian Contract Act, Code of Civil Procedure, Specific Relief Act, Arbitration and Conciliation Act and Commercial Courts Act, based on the chosen matter.
- A manageable set of relevant Supreme Court and High Court judgments; the objective is legal grounding, not comprehensive case-law coverage.

Suggested public sources

India Code: https://www.indiacode.nic.in/indiacode/home.jsp

eCourts Judgments & Orders: https://judgments.ecourts.gov.in/pdfsearch/

Supreme Court of India - SCR Search: https://scr.sci.gov.in/scrsearch/

7. RAG / Agent Requirements

- Support matter-level ingestion and incremental addition of new documents.
- Use retrieval appropriate to the question; the same retrieval plan should not be used for every request.
- Support matter gist, chronology, claims/evidence, court directions, legal research, what changed and hearing preparation.
- Handle contradictions and superseded information when later evidence changes the understanding of the case.
- Return source references for material factual and legal answers.

8. Final Evaluation and Scoring

Judges will use a completely unseen commercial/contract matter. The case will be provided incrementally, similar to real legal work:

- Initial case documents are provided and the team indexes the matter. Judges ask questions on gist, chronology, claims, evidence and court directions.
- Additional documents from the same matter are then provided. The system must ingest them into the existing workspace.
- Judges ask what changed, which earlier understanding is no longer valid, what new evidence or action appeared, and what the current case position is.
- The final test includes hearing preparation using the complete, incrementally built matter.

Scoring

Area	Weight
Answer correctness	25%
Grounding / source traceability	20%
Incremental update handling	20%
Contradiction / supersession handling	15%
Matter understanding / chronology	10%
Retrieval quality	5%
Usability / demo quality	5%